

Anti-dumping duties

India's **imposition** of anti-dumping duties on five Chinese imports **marks** yet another chapter in its long-running trade **friction** with Beijing. With a **ballooning trade deficit** of \$85 billion in 2023-24, New Delhi has once again **signalled** its intent to **safeguard** domestic manufacturers from **predatory** pricing by Chinese exporters. The Directorate General of Trade Remedies (DGTR) recommended these duties on Soft Ferrite Cores, vacuum insulated flasks, aluminium foil, trichloro isocyanuric acid and poly vinyl chloride (PVC) paste resin. These products were **allegedly** being dumped at **artificially** low prices. This move is not **unprecedented**. Earlier this month, the DGTR recommended a 12 per cent **provisional** safeguard duty for 200 days on certain steel products to protect domestic players from a **surge** in imports. As of January 28, 2019, India had **imposed** anti-dumping duties on 99 Chinese products, including chemicals, petrochemicals, fibres, yarn, machinery items, pharmaceuticals, rubber and steel items, to protect its domestic industries from unfair trade practices.

While such measures risk **inflating** costs for domestic consumers, anti-dumping duties are permissible under the World Trade Organisation (WTO) framework. **Article 6** of the General Agreement on Tariffs and Trade (GATT) **allows** countries to **counteract** dumping to ensure fair competition. Thus, India is well within its rights to take corrective measures. However, anti-dumping duties are only a temporary fix. Chinese exporters **often** find ways to **circumvent** such restrictions by **rerouting** shipments through third countries. Indian industries must use this protective **window** to boost their competitiveness rather than rely indefinitely on trade barriers.



A more **sustainable** approach requires deeper reforms — enhanced domestic production capacities, technology upgradation and a focussed strategy to reduce dependence on Chinese imports. As the India-China trade imbalance continues to **widen**, policymakers must balance **protectionist** measures with long-term industrial **self-sufficiency**.

[Practice Exercise]

- Red/blue coloring of words in the sentence indicates subject verb relationship; where 'red' denotes 'subject' and 'blue' denotes 'verb'.

Vocabulary

1. **Anti-dumping duty** (noun) – a tariff imposed on imported goods sold at prices below their fair market value, aiming to protect domestic industries from unfair competition and establish fair trade एंटी-डंपिंग शुल्क
2. **Imposition** (noun) – Enforcement, Levy, Application, Introduction, Establishment लागू करना
3. **Mark** (verb) – Indicate, Signify, Represent, Demonstrate, Denote चिह्नित करना
4. **Friction** (noun) – Conflict, Tension, Disagreement, Discord, Rivalry टकराव/झगड़ा
5. **Ballooning** (adjective) – Expanding, Increasing, Growing, Escalating, Soaring तेजी से बढ़ता हुआ
6. **Trade deficit** (noun) – the amount by which the cost of a country's imports exceeds the value of its exports. व्यापार घाटा
7. **Signal** (verb) – Indicate, Show, Demonstrate, Communicate, Convey संकेत देना
8. **Safeguard** (verb) – Protect, Defend, Shield, Secure, Preserve सुरक्षित रखना
9. **Predatory pricing** (noun) – the pricing of goods or services at such a low level that other firms cannot compete and are forced to leave the market.
10. **Allegedly** (adverb) – Supposedly, Reportedly, Purportedly, Ostensibly, Apparently कथित तौर पर
11. **Artificially** (adverb) – Unnaturally, Synthetically, Fabricatedly, Manipulatively, Forcedly कृत्रिम रूप से
12. **Unprecedented** (adjective) – Unparalleled, Extraordinary, Exceptional, Novel, Unmatched अभूतपूर्व
13. **Provisional** (adjective) – Temporary, Interim, Tentative, Conditional, Preliminary अस्थायी
14. **Surge** (noun) – Increase, Rise, Upsurge, Growth, Spike अचानक वृद्धि
15. **Impose** (verb) – Levy, Enforce, Apply, Introduce, Inflict थोपना
16. **Inflate** (verb) – Increase, Raise, Boost, Amplify, Exaggerate बढ़ाना
17. **Counteract** (verb) – Offset, Neutralize, Counterbalance, Oppose, Resist प्रतिकार करना
18. **Often** (adverb) – Frequently, Regularly, Repeatedly, Commonly, Habitually अक्सर
19. **Circumvent** (verb) – Bypass, Evade, Avoid, Sidestep, Dodge दरकिनार करना

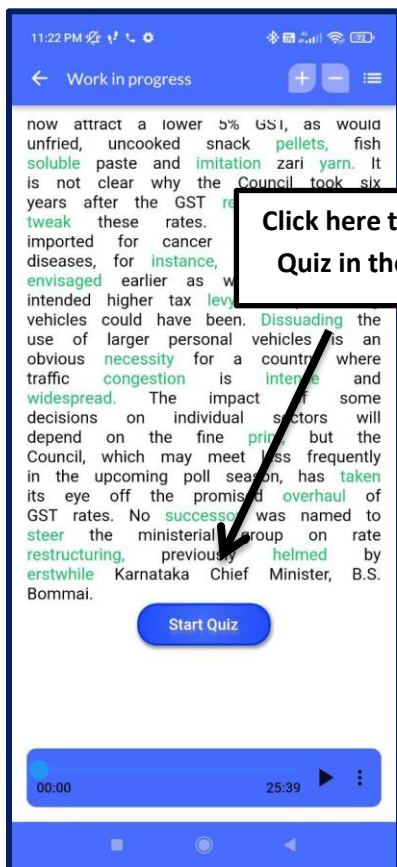
20. **Reroute** (verb) – Redirect, Divert, Reschedule, Rechannel, Readjust मार्ग बदलना
21. **Window** (noun) – Opportunity, Chance, Opening, Interval, Period अवसर
22. **Sustainable** (adjective) – Maintainable, Enduring, Viable, Renewable, Eco-friendly टिकाऊ
23. **Widen** (verb) – Broaden, Expand, Extend, Increase, Enlarge विस्तार करना
24. **Protectionist** (adjective) – Restrictive, Defensive, Isolationist, Nationalistic, Mercantilist संरक्षणवादी
25. **Self-sufficiency** (noun) – Independence, Autarky, Self-reliance, Self-support, Self-sustenance आत्मनिर्भरता

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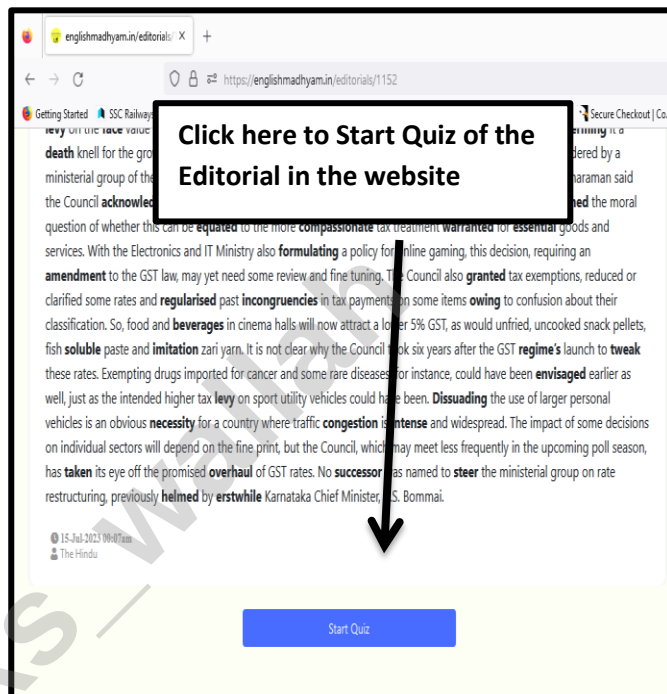
Summary of the Editorial

1. **India-China Trade Friction:** India has imposed anti-dumping duties on five Chinese imports to address trade imbalances.
2. **Growing Trade Deficit:** India's trade deficit with China reached \$85 billion in 2023-24, prompting protective measures.
3. **Targeted Products:** Duties apply to Soft Ferrite Cores, vacuum flasks, aluminium foil, trichloro isocyanuric acid, and PVC paste resin.
4. **Predatory Pricing Concerns:** Chinese firms allegedly dumped these goods at artificially low prices, harming Indian manufacturers.
5. **Previous Measures:** India has 99 anti-dumping duties on Chinese products since 2019, covering chemicals, steel, pharmaceuticals, etc.
6. **Recent Safeguard Duty:** A 12% provisional duty was imposed on certain steel imports for 200 days to curb surges.
7. **WTO Compliance:** Anti-dumping duties are allowed under WTO rules (GATT Article 6) to ensure fair trade.
8. **Temporary Solution:** Such duties offer short-term relief but do not address long-term competitiveness.
9. **Circumvention Tactics:** Chinese exporters often reroute goods via third countries to bypass restrictions.
10. **Consumer Impact:** Higher duties may increase costs for Indian buyers of these products.
11. **Need for Industrial Upgradation:** Indian firms must improve efficiency and technology during this protection period.
12. **Reducing Import Dependence:** India should focus on boosting domestic production to cut reliance on Chinese goods.
13. **Policy Balance:** The government must combine protectionism with self-sufficiency strategies.
14. **Long-Term Reforms Needed:** Sustainable solutions include better infrastructure, R&D, and supply chain resilience.
15. **Strategic Trade Policy:** India must strengthen its manufacturing base while managing trade relations with China.

Practice Exercise: SSC Pattern Based



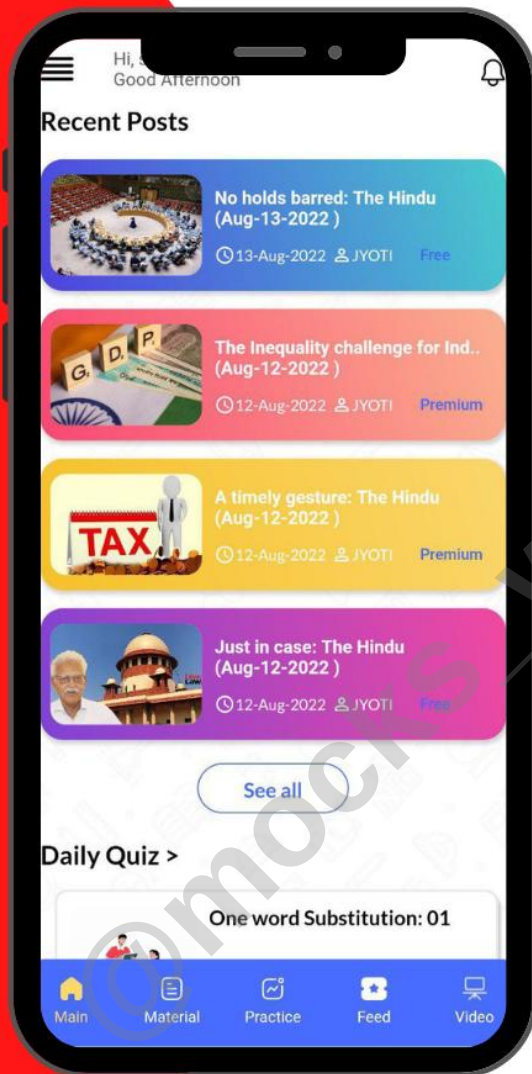
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